

BRAGANZA DOWRY

In 1662, the Portuguese princess Catherine of Braganza married the English king, Charles II. Her considerable dowry included chests of tea, already a popular drink among the Portuguese nobility, as well as the the port of Bombay, which would become the EIC's trading headquarters in the Far East, allowing them to export tea all around the world. At this time, tea was not widely consumed in England, but Queen Catherine's fondness for the drink improved its popularity at court.

1662

Charles II, King of England, marries Portuguese princess Catherine of Braganza and tea drinking becomes popular among the British nobility



Assam tea



RUSSIAN TEA

Tea was introduced to Russia in 1638, but it was only after the Tea Camel Road was established that the Russians enjoyed a steady supply.

WHAT'S IN A NAME?

Since Europeans traded with tea merchants who spoke the Amoy dialect of China, they adopted their word "tay" for tea. This became "tea" in English, "thé" in French, "thee" in Dutch, and "tee" in German.

1689

The Tea Camel Road connects Russia and Mongolia, via Siberia, boosting tea trade between the countries

1676

The rise in popularity of tea in Britain leads King Charles II to introduce a 119 percent taxation on tea

1773

Dissatisfaction over taxation in the American colonies leads to the "Boston Tea Party," in which a shipment of tea is dumped into the harbor

THE SMUGGLING TRADE

The high taxation on tea in Britain led to a thriving trade in tea smuggling. Tea was smuggled in to Britain from Europe via the Channel Islands and the Isle of Man. Although smuggling was widespread in the early 18th century, individual smugglers operated on a very small scale using small boats, sometimes even rowing boats, to bring fewer than 60 chests of tea to shore at a time.



BRITISH COLONIES

Tea was enjoyed in the British colonies in North America, although it was highly taxed. To protest the British policy of taxation without representation, American colonists dumped a shipment of tea into Boston Harbor on December 16, 1773. The "Boston Tea Party" precipitated the American Revolution (1775-1783).